

Activity

Generate Ideas: Recycling Business Concepts

1. Spend a day searching the internet to find stories of entrepreneurs who started interesting businesses that are located in another country. Some good websites to begin with are:

<http://www.businessinsider.com/>

<http://www.entrepreneur.com/>

<http://www.google.com/>

<http://www.businessesforsale.com/>

2. As you read an article about each small business ask yourself some questions:

- What is the primary need this company appears to be trying to fill?
- Would the people in my community likely have a similar need for this type of business and could I introduce something similar locally?

If the answers are “yes” then document the business concepts below:

Name of company # 1	City, country of headquarters:	Website
OLX Pakistan	Lahore, Pakistan	https://www.olx.com.pk
Business concept & need being filled:		
<u>An online classifieds marketplace that allows users to buy, sell, and trade a wide variety of new and used items—from electronics to furniture—locally and regionally.</u>		
How I could improve this idea:		
<u>Implement a Verified Seller System where only verified buyers can leave ratings and reviews. This will enhance trust, ensure seller accountability, and help buyers make informed decisions, creating a more reliable marketplace.</u>		

3. Another approach is to call a member of the family or a friend located far away and asks them if they know of any innovative or note-worthy businesses near where they live. Or if you are going to university far from home you can always just walk around town and see if there are any local businesses worth emulating back at home. Either way, write down a few notes about each idea so you can add these new business concepts to the interesting ones you learned about via the internet.
4. Repeat step 2 as you read articles or hear about other small businesses:
 - What is the primary need this additional company appears to be trying to fill?
 - Would the people in my community likely have a similar need for this type of business and could I introduce something similar locally? If answer is “yes” then document the business concept below.

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Student Name: Muhammad Hassan Khalid

Name of company # 2 SastaTicket	City, country of headquarters: Karachi, Pakistan	Website https://www.sastaticket.pk
Business concept & need being filled: <u>An online travel booking platform offering competitive prices for flights, buses, and hotels, catering to cost-conscious travelers.</u> 		
How I could improve this idea: <u>Introduce a loyalty or rewards program.</u> <u>Offer personalized travel recommendations and last-minute deals.</u> <u>Enhance customer service with multilingual support.</u> 		

5. Repeat this process in the spaces that follow:

Name of company # 3 Swvl	City, country of headquarters: Dubai, United Arab Emirates	Website https://www.swvl.com
Business concept & need being filled: <u>A mass transit startup providing on-demand bus services to ease urban commuting and reduce traffic congestion.</u> 		
How I could improve this idea: <u>Expand the fleet to include eco-friendly electric buses.</u> <u>Collaborate with city administrations to cover underserved areas.</u> 		

Name of company # 4 Careem	City, country of headquarters: Dubai, United Arab Emirates	Website https://www.careem.com
Business concept & need being filled: <u>A ride-hailing service offering reliable and convenient transportation, reducing dependency on personal vehicles in congested urban areas.</u> 		
How I could improve this idea: <u>Introduce carpooling options to lower costs and reduce congestion.</u> <u>Expand services to suburban and rural areas with tailored pricing.</u> 		

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Name of company # 5 PayFast Pakistan	City, country of headquarters: Karachi, Pakistan	Website https://gopayfast.com/
Business concept & need being filled: PayFast is a digital payment gateway that allows businesses to accept online payments securely through multiple channels, including debit/credit cards, mobile wallets, and bank transfers. It bridges the gap for businesses that want to operate online by providing seamless integration with e-commerce platforms, subscription-based services, and digital marketplaces.		
How I could improve this idea: Enhance fraud detection systems with AI-driven analytics for real-time security monitoring. Offer customized payment plans for small businesses and startups. Develop a user-friendly mobile app for merchants to track transactions and manage payments efficiently.		

6. Review the business concepts listed above and circle the top concepts that you feel are most interesting and promising.

If you'd like to generate more business ideas then you may want to try:

- Combining two of your existing ideas together to create an interesting new idea
- Analyzing an industry that is rapidly growing or that you find interesting to seek what problems people in this industry may be facing and what opportunities may exist to solve these problems
- Re doing any of the four strategies already reviewed in this packet to generate even more ideas

Home Task 1

Listing of ideas that you are interested

The key aim of this assignment is to generate at least 5 ideas that interest you. You should try to identify gaps and weaknesses in existing products/services available in the market. You can also observe your community of residence and think about key challenges or issues which your community is facing daily. After generating ideas of your interest, enlist them into the given template.

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Enlist your ideas



Smart Recycling Kiosks – Automated machines that reward users for recycling plastic, paper, and aluminum waste.



Eco-Friendly Packaging Solutions – Producing biodegradable and compostable packaging materials for local businesses.



Upcycled Furniture & Decor – Creating furniture and home decor from discarded wood, metal, and plastic.



E-Waste Recycling & Repurposing – Collecting and refurbishing electronic waste for resale or proper disposal.



Organic Composting Service – Offering composting bins and organic waste collection services for households and businesses.

How to Quickly Evaluate Ideas

After you generate a good number of new business ideas you will need to determine which ideas are most promising and which ideas to cross off.

1. For each of the best business ideas you generated, write each idea in the BUSINESS IDEA sections of the following pages (one idea per section). This will make it easier to evaluate each idea quickly.
2. In the section below, write your answers clearly and concisely to the three key questions listed about your business idea.

BUSINESS IDEA # 1 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Automated kiosks placed in high-traffic areas where users can deposit recyclable materials in exchange for rewards (discounts, vouchers, or cashback).	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Encouraging recycling with incentives	9
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) Urban communities, environmentally conscious individuals, local authorities	8
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: Promotes sustainability with smart technology	10
Total Score (a+b+c)	27

3. The rate of your answers from 1-10 in the “Rate each answer from 1-10” column on the right. An Outstanding idea with a compelling need should be rated a 10, an idea with a clearly defined target market should be rated a 10, and an incredibly interesting and exciting idea should be rated a 10. Anything less should be rated lower. A rating of 1 is the lowest rating. Most answers will likely fall in between and should be rated accordingly. So, rate each answer listed above.
4. Add your three ratings together to comprise your total score (maximum total is 30) which you should write in the shaded TOTAL SCORE section above for future comparison.

BUSINESS IDEA # 2 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Manufacturing sustainable, biodegradable packaging for businesses looking to reduce plastic usage.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Reducing plastic waste, meeting environmental regulations	9
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Retailers, restaurants, e-commerce businesses	9
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: Growing demand for green alternatives	8
Total Score (a+b+c)	26

BUSINESS IDEA # 3 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Creating unique furniture and decor items using discarded or repurposed materials.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Reducing waste, offering affordable sustainable furniture	8
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Homeowners, small businesses, eco-conscious customers	7
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: Creative and eco-friendly concept	9
Total Score (a+b+c)	24
BUSINESS IDEA # 4 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Collecting, recycling, and repurposing electronic waste, ensuring proper disposal or refurbishment for resale.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Safe disposal of hazardous e-waste, recovering valuable materials	9
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Individuals, corporations, electronic retailers	8
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: Addresses a critical environmental issue	9
Total Score (a+b+c)	26
BUSINESS IDEA # 5 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Providing composting bins and a collection service for households and businesses to convert organic waste into fertilizer.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Reducing landfill waste, producing natural fertilizer	9
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Households, restaurants, community gardens	8
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: Encourages sustainable living	8
Total Score (a+b+c)	25



Generating and Screening Ideas



Step 1: Expand your list if possible: As you have already developed a list of 5 ideas according to your interest. Now think about your personal interests, your desired lifestyle, your values, what you feel you are likely to do very well, and contributions you would like to make.

Sustainable Energy Solutions for Homes – Offering affordable solar panel and energy-efficient home solutions to reduce energy consumption and promote sustainability.

Plant-Based Meal Delivery – A service providing nutritious, eco-friendly, plant-based meal options for health-conscious individuals and those looking to reduce their environmental impact.

Eco-Friendly Cleaning Products – A line of biodegradable, non-toxic, and effective cleaning products for homes and businesses, reducing reliance on harsh chemicals.

Local Sustainable Farming Network – A platform that connects local farmers growing organic produce with consumers in their area, promoting fresh and eco-friendly food choices.

Electric Vehicle Charging Stations – A network of charging stations for electric vehicles, making eco-friendly transportation more accessible in urban areas.

Step 2: Ask at least three people who know you well to look at your list, and revise your list to reflect any new ideas emerging from this exchange.

Smart Recycling Kiosks – They loved the concept of incentivizing recycling but suggested expanding the target market to include schools and universities.

Organic Composting Service – This idea was praised for its environmental benefits, but they recommended offering it as a subscription-based service for businesses, with the added benefit of turning organic waste into compost for their own use.

Sustainable Energy Solutions for Homes – People were excited about this idea, especially as it aligns with growing trends in eco-conscious living. One suggestion was to integrate it with smart home systems for better energy management.

Plant-Based Meal Delivery – This idea was well-received, but they noted that it could be expanded to cater to different dietary needs (gluten-free, keto, etc.), to appeal to a wider audience.





Step 3: Jot down insights, observations, and conclusions that have emerged about your business ideas or your personal preferences. Which ones solve the greatest pain point/aggravation/frustration for which you (and others you have spoken with) would pay a significant premium to eliminate?

Smart Recycling Kiosks solves the frustration of lack of recycling incentives and makes it easy for people to participate. This idea could offer significant value to both urban communities and businesses with sustainability goals.

Sustainable Energy Solutions for Homes stands out as it tackles the long-term need for energy efficiency, with a growing market of eco-conscious homeowners. If integrated with smart technology, it could offer more convenience and savings, appealing to a premium market.

The business ideas that address the most significant frustrations seem to be those around recycling and sustainable energy, both of which are crucial for the future of the planet. People are willing to pay a premium for solutions that align with their values and contribute to a healthier, more sustainable environment.
